





within a piece of furniture that catch you off guard, a whimsical flourish here, an immaculate joint there. "Out of all the crafts we work with, I personally enjoy *parchin kari* the most because the possibilities are infinite," says Sonal. The industry agrees; Within was recently awarded the Brand of the Year accolade for their pioneering work in the historic inlay craft.

When I press her on her current obsessions, she doesn't point to a standard sofa or a commercially viable coffee table. Instead, she brings up 7 Days, a spectacular, highly complex monochromatic collection that uses seven different stones to narrate the biblical creation story.

"It takes a long time to create each piece," she admits with the pride of a patient artist. "We've just finished our second piece and are moving to the third. It will easily take us another year just to finish the collection." Alongside it sit recent masterpieces like Rozan e Kashmir and the freshly previewed collectible lines Samudra Manthan and Navratan.

To understand Within is to understand that the studio suffers from a beautiful, productive case of creative restlessness. Sonal refuses to be boxed into a singular category. Ask her what she prefers designing, and the answer is an immediate, enthusiastic, "everything". The brand has systematically fractured its genius into clear verticals: fine furniture, art furniture, art and sculpture, lighting and millwork. Every single piece is birthed locally in Delhi, manufactured either in their own unit or through exclusive, tightly knit craft clusters across India who work solely to bring Within's ambitious visions to life.

So, what happens when a brand that started as a hidden, word-of-mouth experience centre finally conquers a four-storey landmark on the main road? They look for the next horizon. There is a massive secret brewing for October. Hints of a new destination are dropped, then quickly cloaked in delightful, superstitious mystery. "We've been trying to announce it for months, but it's a total jinx until it happens," laughs Sonal, tightly guarding the name of the next city they are set to conquer.

We might not know where the boat is steering next, but with passion and a relentless appetite for reinventing Indian craft, Within's next chapter is bound to be just like their furniture, beautiful, meticulous and impossible to ignore.